

The Cosmere Reading Order

Sanderson says there's no single mandatory Cosmere order — several books work as entry points. This is the spoiler-conscious path: Mistborn Era 1 first, Secret History only after The Bands of Mourning (his own rule — it torpedoed Era 1 otherwise), Warbreaker before Words of Radiance for a quiet payoff, and The Sunlit Man last. Notes flag the slots that are genuinely flexible. (The Frugal Wizard's Handbook isn't Cosmere, so it isn't here.)

■ MISTBORN — ERA 1 ■ MISTBORN — ERA 2 ■ THE STORMLIGHT ARCHIVE ■ STANDALONES & NOVELLAS

01	☐	Mistborn: The Final Empire
02	☐	The Well of Ascension
03	☐	The Hero of Ages
04	☐	Tress of the Emerald Sea flexible — works any time after Mistborn Era 1
05	☐	The Alloy of Law
06	☐	Shadows of Self
07	☐	The Bands of Mourning
08	☐	Mistborn: Secret History Sanderson's rule: only after The Bands of Mourning — massive Era 1 spoilers
09	☐	Warbreaker read before Words of Radiance for a payoff; free ebook on Sanderson's site
10	☐	Elantris flexible — Sanderson's first novel, readable anywhere
11	☐	The Emperor's Soul Hugo-winning novella in the Elantris world
12	☐	The Way of Kings
13	☐	Words of Radiance
14	☐	Edgedancer novella — read before Oathbringer
15	☐	Oathbringer
16	☐	Dawnshard novella — read before Rhythm of War
17	☐	Rhythm of War
18	☐	Yumi and the Nightmare Painter best after Rhythm of War
19	☐	The Lost Metal heavy Cosmere crossover — lands hardest this late in the path
20	☐	Wind and Truth
21	☐	The Sunlit Man read last — it follows Stormlight's endgame